

History
HISTORY 2RF3
The Rise, Fall and Rise Again of Far
Right Populism and Authoritarianism
Winter 2027



Instructor Information

Stephen Heathorn
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Office Hours:
TBD

Course Information

Lectures: Tu & W, 12:30-1:20

Tutorials: Yes. Scheduled by Registrar.

Course Dates: 01/04/2027 - 04/07/2027

Units: 3.00

Course Delivery Mode: In Person

Course Description: An analysis of the origins and development of modern far right political movements from the early 20th century to the early 21st century. Topics will include: 19th antecedents; early cultural modernism; Mussolini's Italy; Franco's Spain; Hitler's Germany; Salazar's Portugal; the original America First movement; Peron's Argentina; Hungary; Brexit; MAGA. Three hours (lectures and tutorials), one term Prerequisite(s): Registration in Level II or above

Instructor-Specific Course Information

This course examines the historical origins, growth, defeat and then rebirth of far right authoritarianism and populism. It critically explores the ideas behind these

movements and why they have historically been popular, as well as why such movements have had tragic consequences and legacies.

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)
- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)
- [eReserves](#)
- [Open Education Resources](#)

Course Learning Outcomes

- To think about historical interpretation and the nature of historical evidence
- To develop analytical and critical reading abilities, time-management and note-taking skills, and to improve oral and written communication skills
- To demonstrate the ability to produce insightful, articulate, and error-free formal written work of substance
- To acquire and demonstrate an understanding of the subject content of the course, including the ability to synthesize ideas, interpretations and factual information derived from the books, the specialized readings, and the lectures.

Required Materials and Texts

Please sign in with your MacID [here](#) to view your booklist

No required textbooks. Readings will be supplied using Avenue2Learn.

Class Format

In Person

The lectures are an essential part of this class and, as there is no textbook, attendance in class and the development of note taking is required to do well. All lectures will have an outline available on Avenue prior to class, but this does not

substitute for lecture notes. I will also record the lectures and make them available immediately to those with excused absences from class (eg. MSAF etc.) or for those with SAS accommodations. I will make all the lecture recordings available to the entire course at the end of the term in the period immediately prior to the final exam. The recordings are not a perfect substitute for attendance in class, and I make no guarantees about the quality of the recorded lectures.

Tutorials will meet weekly and will primarily be discussions of assigned reading provided on Avenue2Learn. There are 10 tutorials spaced over the course but only 8 will be counted in the tutorial mark, so you can miss 2 for whatever reason and still earn full marks for tutorials. Tutorial participation marks are broken down into attendance (1.5% for attending per tutorial), and actual participation grade (upto 2% per tutorial) based on the amount and quality of participation. Students will have the opportunity to self-assess their performance in tutorial at the end of each class, which will be considered in the marking of participation, but the final decision on the mark rests with the TA.

Course Evaluation

Tutorial Participation: 28%

Paper:

Proposal and Annotated Bibliography (1000 words): 10%

Final Draft of Paper (2500 words): 20%

In-class Mid-Term: 12%

Two-Hour Final Exam: 30%

Undergraduate Grading Scale

The grades breakdown for McMaster's 12-Point Grading Scale

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
C+	6	67-69
C	5	63-66

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
C-	4	60-62
D+	3	57-59
D	2	53-56
D-	1	50-52
F	0	0-49

Course Schedule

Week of 4 Jan: Introduction to Course and Concepts/Definitions

Week of 11 Jan: French Revolution, Romanticism & Growth of Reactionary Right
1st Tutorial

Week of 18 Jan: 19th Century Scientific Racism; Social Darwinism & Eugenics
2nd Tutorial

Week of 25 Jan: Ultramontanism in France; the Dreyfus Affair; Cultural Modernism
3rd Tutorial

Week of 1 Feb: Italian Fascism
4th Tutorial

Week of 8 Feb: Fascism cont. and in-class **Mid-term, Wed. 10 Feb.**
No Tutorial

Week of 15 Feb. Reading Week

Week of 22 Feb: Nazi Germany
5th Tutorial
Proposal and Annotated Bibliography Due, Midnight 26 Feb.

Week of 1 Mar: 20th C. Spain and Portugal
6th Tutorial

Week of 8 Mar: Peronism and the Far Right in Latin America

7th Tutorial

Week of 15 Mar: Rise of Religious-Nationalist Authoritarians: Turkey, India, Russia

8th Tutorial

Week of 22 Mar: The EU and Resurgence of Far-Right Populism in Europe; Brexit

9th Tutorial

Week of 29 Mar: Authoritarian Populism in America: America First; Trump/MAGA

10th Tutorial

Final Draft of Paper Due, Midnight 2 Apr.

Week of 5 Apr: Conclusion and Review

No Tutorial

Final Exam TBD -- Scheduled by Registrar.

Late Assignments

Late assignments are penalized at the rate of 3% per day.

Turnitin.com

This course uses web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Generative AI: Use Prohibited

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it “shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source”. This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also stated in the policy is the following, “Contract Cheating is the act of “outsourcing of student work to third parties” (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p. 639) with or without payment.” Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: “Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty”), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](#).

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one’s own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

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Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, user names for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or

other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the “Code”). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online**.

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students’ access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University’s [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, Indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.